

Pronto

House Help Platform: Fulfillment and Communication Gaps

Document Type	Product Teardown and Feature Proposal
Focus Area	Partner Assignment Delay, No Live Tracking, Poor Resolution Flow
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Based On	Personal user experience with Pronto app, Gurgaon
Benchmark	Urban Company: house help and on-demand service platform
GitHub	github.com/harsh112003/used-car-analysis

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Core problems identified	User personas covered	Root cause identified	Product recommendations

This teardown examines three interconnected product failures in Pronto's house help booking experience. Partners are assigned only 15 minutes before the booking time, making live tracking impossible. When a partner does not show up, there is no automatic rescheduling or proactive communication. The only resolution path is manual cancellation followed by a slow refund process through a sluggish chatbot. Together, these three failures directly erode customer retention in a segment where trust and reliability are the entire value proposition.

Pronto is a house help focused platform operating in the Gurgaon and Delhi NCR region. Unlike Urban Company which offers a broad range of home services including cleaning, plumbing, and beauty, Pronto is singularly focused on house help. This singular focus is both its USP and its vulnerability. When house help fulfillment fails, there is no fallback service to retain the customer. Every failure is a complete failure.

The house help market in urban India is one of the last major unorganised segments. Most households still rely on word-of-mouth references or direct hiring. Platforms like Pronto are attempting to organise this market by offering scheduled, verified house help on-demand. The promise is simple: book in advance, get reliable help at the right time. The problem is that this promise is frequently broken, and the product does not handle that breakage gracefully.

What Pronto Does Well	Where the Gaps Are
Focused entirely on house help, which builds specialised trust in one service category Offers both instant and scheduled bookings Provides sub-service options: utensil cleaning, house cleaning, plant care, clothes cleaning Affordable pricing with clear service categories	Partner is assigned only 15 minutes before booking regardless of advance booking time No live tracking or ETA for the house help No automatic rescheduling when partner is unavailable Customer support relies on slow chatbot with delayed human escalation Cancellation triggers a full refund cycle with no retention mechanism

Three distinct user archetypes were identified based on real usage patterns in urban households in Gurgaon and Delhi NCR. Each persona depends on house help in a different way but all three experience the same core product failures with compounding consequences.

Persona 1: Sunita, 42, Homemaker

Profile	Goals	Impact of Failure
Age: 42 City: Gurgaon Role: Full-time homemaker and household manager Tech comfort: Moderate Booking style: Pre-books morning slots regularly	Coordinate house help with daily schedule of cooking, errands, and household tasks Have help arrive at a predictable time so she can plan her day accordingly	When help does not show up with no notice, she must do all chores herself on top of everything else planned No tracking means she waits at home without knowing whether to expect anyone Refund process feels like added work on an already stressful day

Persona 2: Harsh, 27, Working Professional

Profile	Goals	Impact of Failure
Age: 27 City: Gurgaon, Sector 84 Role: Salaried professional with fixed daily routine Tech comfort: High Booking style: Pre-books the night before or early morning before leaving	House is cleaned before or while he is at work No waiting required, help arrives at scheduled time and completes work Return home to a clean space without disruption to work schedule	If help does not show up and there is no communication, he either leaves the house dirty or waits and gets late for work Actual booking evidence: app showed booking placed but partner was never assigned and booking was eventually cancelled with no proactive notification

REAL EVIDENCE

A real booking placed on the Pronto app showed the confirmation screen with the message: "We are sorry for the delay. We are still finding the right partner for your booking and will update you soon." The booking was for Hourly Services, 1 hour, at Rs 99, for an address in Sector 84, Manesar, Gurgaon. The partner was never assigned and the booking was eventually cancelled. This is not an edge case. It represents the core reliability gap in Pronto's fulfillment system.

Persona 3: Neha, 35, Working Mother

Profile	Goals	Impact of Failure
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Age: 35 City: Gurgaon Role: Full-time job and primary household manager Tech comfort: High Booking style: Books weekly slots in advance to maintain routine	House chores shared between self and scheduled help Morning routine runs on a tight schedule including school drop, cooking, and leaving for office Dependency on help is high and non-negotiable	A no-show from house help cascades into a disrupted morning for the entire family School runs, cooking, and office timings all affected simultaneously Having to deal with a slow chatbot support flow during an already stressful morning is the worst possible customer experience
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03 Problem 1: Late Partner Assignment

Pronto assigns a house help partner only 15 minutes before the scheduled booking time. This happens regardless of how far in advance the customer pre-booked. A booking made 12 hours in advance receives the same 15-minute assignment window as a last-minute booking. This is the root cause of every other problem in this teardown.

WHY THIS IS THE ROOT CAUSE

Because assignment happens at T minus 15 minutes, Pronto has no partner to track before that point. This makes live tracking structurally impossible. It also means that if no partner is available in those 15 minutes, the booking fails with zero advance warning to the customer. Urban Company assigns the partner immediately after booking is confirmed, which is why it can offer live tracking and proactive delay communication throughout the entire pre-service window.

Pronto vs Urban Company: Partner Assignment

PRONTO

Partner is assigned only 15 minutes before the booking time. No tracking is possible before this window. If no partner is found in 15 minutes, the booking fails silently.

URBAN COMPANY

Partner is assigned immediately after booking confirmation. Customer can track the partner from the moment of assignment. ETA is available at all times.

03b Problem 2: No Live Tracking or Delay Communication

Because partner assignment is delayed to 15 minutes before the booking, there is no entity to track during the pre-service window. Even if a partner is assigned on time, there is no live location tracking, no ETA display, and no proactive delay notification. The customer simply waits without any information.

Pronto vs Urban Company: Live Tracking

PRONTO

No live tracking at any point. No ETA shown. No delay notification sent. Customer has no information about whether the partner is on the way, delayed, or cancelled.

URBAN COMPANY

Live tracking shown from the moment of assignment. ETA updates in real time. If partner is delayed, a message is sent proactively: the partner will arrive in X minutes. Mostly delays are in minutes, not hours.

03c Problem 3: Poor Resolution and Customer Support Flow

When a partner does not show up or a booking fails, the resolution path is entirely manual and friction-heavy. The customer must either cancel themselves or wait for Pronto to cancel from their end. Either way, the refund process is initiated, which takes time and requires the customer to actively follow up. There is no automatic rescheduling to the

next available slot, which is a feature Urban Company offers as standard.

The Support Experience

1	Booking Fails or Partner Does Not Show Customer waits past the booking time with no communication. Either the app cancels the booking or the customer cancels manually.
2	Customer Contacts Support Opens the app and reaches a chatbot. The bot is slow, generic, and cannot resolve fulfilment issues autonomously.
3	Escalates to Human Representative After multiple bot interactions, customer reaches a human on chat only. Response times are slow. The conversation is text-heavy and manual.
4	Refund Initiated Refund is processed but takes time to reflect. Customer has to track it separately. No automatic rescheduling is offered.
5	Customer Churns Having gone through the full failure cycle with no proactive communication, no auto-reschedule, and a slow refund, the customer loses trust and does not rebook.

Pronto vs Urban Company: Resolution Flow

PRONTO Manual cancellation or app-side cancellation. Refund cycle begins. No auto-reschedule offered. Support is chatbot first with slow human escalation. Customer must follow up actively.	URBAN COMPANY If partner is unavailable, Insta Help or next available slot is offered automatically. Refund or reschedule choice is given instantly. Support is faster and more contextual.
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All three problems trace back to a single structural decision in Pronto's fulfillment model: the platform does not pre-commit a partner to a booking at the time of confirmation. Instead, it operates a just-in-time assignment model where partner matching happens only in the final 15-minute window before the service.

THE STRUCTURAL PROBLEM

Just-in-time assignment might work in a high-density, high-supply environment. But in Pronto's current supply situation, particularly during periods of partner scarcity such as regional events, festivals, or elections when Bengali house help partners return home, the 15-minute window is insufficient to find a replacement. The product has no graceful degradation path. When the 15-minute window fails, the entire experience fails.

Problem	Root Cause	User Impact
Late partner assignment	Platform does not pre-commit partners at booking confirmation time	No tracking possible. No advance warning of failure.
No live tracking	No assigned partner exists to track until T minus 15 minutes	Customer waits with zero information about service status.
No auto-reschedule	No fallback logic exists when the 15-minute window fails to find a partner	Customer must manually cancel and wait for refund, losing trust entirely.
Poor support flow	Support is designed for query resolution, not real-time fulfilment failure management	Slow chatbot adds friction exactly when the customer is most frustrated.

Feature 1: Early Partner Assignment at Booking Confirmation

Shift partner assignment from T minus 15 minutes to the moment of booking confirmation. When a customer books a slot 12 hours in advance, a partner should be reserved and confirmed within minutes of that booking. This is the single most impactful structural change because it unblocks live tracking, enables proactive delay communication, and gives Pronto enough time to find a replacement if the assigned partner cancels.

Feature 2: Live Partner Tracking with ETA

Once early assignment is in place, introduce live tracking in the app showing the partner's location and ETA from the time of assignment. If the partner is delayed, send a proactive push notification with the updated arrival time. This mirrors what Urban Company already does and is the minimum expectation of a modern service platform.

Feature 3: Automatic Rescheduling with Customer Choice

If a partner cancels or cannot be found, trigger an automatic rescheduling flow rather than a cancellation flow. Show the customer the next two available slots and let them choose between rescheduling or taking a full refund. This retains the customer in the booking funnel instead of pushing them into the refund cycle and reducing the chance they rebook.

Feature 4: Contextual Support for Fulfilment Failures

When a booking fails or a partner is not assigned on time, bypass the generic chatbot entirely and surface a direct contextual card in the app: "Your partner was not assigned. Here is what you can do: reschedule to the next available slot, get a full refund now, or call support directly." This removes the chatbot friction at the exact moment when the customer is most frustrated and most likely to churn.

Feature 5: Supply Buffer During Known Scarcity Periods

Pronto has experienced partner scarcity during regional events such as Bengali elections when a significant portion of house help partners return home. The platform should build a supply forecasting model that identifies low-supply periods in advance and either restricts bookings to available capacity or proactively communicates expected delays to customers before they book.

Feature 1 is the prerequisite for Features 2 and 3. Nothing else can be built meaningfully until early partner assignment is in place. Features 3 and 4 are independent of each other and can be built in parallel in the next sprint.

Feature	Dependency	Impact	Effort	Priority
F1: Early partner assignment	None	High	High	P0: Do Now
F2: Live tracking with ETA	Needs F1	High	Medium	P1: After F1
F3: Auto-reschedule flow	None	High	Medium	P1: Next Sprint
F4: Contextual failure support	None	High	Low	P1: Next Sprint
F5: Supply buffer forecasting	None	Medium	High	P2: Roadmap

Success Metrics

Note: All metrics below are directional. Baselines should be instrumented before numeric targets are defined. These are the right indicators to track, not assumed numbers.

Metric	Why It Matters	How to Measure
Partner assignment success rate within booking window	Measures whether early assignment is working and supply is sufficient	Percentage of bookings where partner is assigned more than 1 hour before service time
Booking completion rate	Primary indicator of fulfilment reliability across all three personas	Bookings completed as scheduled divided by total bookings placed
Auto-reschedule acceptance rate	Measures whether customers prefer rescheduling over refund when given the choice	Reschedules accepted divided by total failed bookings where reschedule was offered
Refund request rate	Tracks whether fulfilment failures and auto-reschedule reduce the refund cycle load	Refund requests per 100 bookings before and after feature launch
30-day rebooking rate	The ultimate retention metric: do customers come back after a failure?	Customers who rebook within 30 days of a failed booking experience

Support ticket volume for fulfilment failures	Measures whether contextual failure cards reduce chatbot contact rate	Support tickets tagged as fulfilment failure per 100 failed bookings
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CLOSING THOUGHT

Pronto's singular focus on house help is a strength if it is executed reliably. Right now, the just-in-time assignment model undermines that reliability every single time supply is tight. The fix is not complex in principle: assign earlier, communicate proactively, and give customers a graceful path when things go wrong. These three things alone would transform Pronto from a platform that customers use with low confidence into one they recommend to others. In a category built entirely on trust, that is the difference between retention and churn.